

Forge The Future *Summit* page

Forty-seven changes across seventeen sections of ventriq.io/summit — ordered by what ships first. Every copy replacement below is final and drop-in ready. Nothing here requires a writing pass.

PREPARED BY
Justin Shaw

DATE
July 25, 2026

PAGE
ventriq.io/summit

LIVE DATE
August 1, 2026

How to work this document

Read the priority order first. Everything after it is reference.

TWO TAGS

JUSTIN marks a change requested directly. **COPY AUDIT** marks a change surfaced in the conversion review. Both carry equal weight — the tag only tells you where it came from if you need to ask a question about it.

COPY BLOCKS

Grey boxes are what is on the page today. Gold boxes are the replacement. Copy the gold box verbatim, including punctuation and em dashes. Where two options appear, the one marked **recommended** is the default unless told otherwise.

SCOPE

This brief covers the summit page only. The full site still needs revision, but the summit page is receiving partner newsletter traffic in early August and takes priority over everything else. Two cross-site items are flagged in Section 17 because they cannot wait.

ONE OPEN ITEM

Section 10 carries a pending decision on the words *founders* versus *entrepreneurs* sitewide. It is written the recommended way and flagged in place. Do not resolve it independently.



Priority order

If time runs short, work top to bottom and stop where you have to.

Tier 1 Today — credibility leaks currently visible to the public

- Remove every instance of placeholder text: **ANNOUNCE-DATE** (twice), **speaker 01–15**, and the word **SPEAKERS** beside all eight session titles.
- Remove the internal legal note from the footer: *EIN — add when issued; no deductibility language until determination letter*. This is instruction copy, not public copy.
- Remove all nonprofit language sitewide. Ventriq is a for-profit entity as of now. Five instances on this page, more across the site. Full detail in Section 17.
- Standardize the event name to **Forge The Future Summit** in the title tag, meta descriptions, top banner, and hero.
- Correct the speaker count from *thirty-plus* to *seventeen-plus* in two places.

Tier 2 By August 1 — structural, requires build time

- Persistent mobile CTA bar. Highest-value single change on this list.
- Analytics and conversion tracking live before the partner push begins.
- End-to-end Luma test with a real submission, including the referral-name field.
- RSVP button beneath the schedule breakdown.
- VIRTUAL promoted to a large display line in the hero.
- Discipline tags added to all eight session titles.
- Sponsor block relocated below the FAQ.

Tier 3 Drop-in copy replacements — no engineering required

- Fourteen copy blocks, all written and final. Sections 2, 4, 5, 6, 7, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15.
- CTA label standardized to a single phrase in all five places it appears.

Tier 4 After launch — improves the page, does not block it

- Sticky anchor sub-navigation.
- Speaker grid rebuilt to render cleanly at any count.
- Founders After Hours section built behind a toggle, switched on during Night 1.
- Mobile QA pass on the countdown timer and scrolling marquee.



Who this page is speaking to

Context for every copy decision that follows. National virtual audience, Maryland-weighted.

01

Idea & pre-launch

Need conviction and foundational credibility. Pull hardest toward Night 1 leadership and Night 2 brand.

02

Early-stage operators

Zero to three years in. The core audience. Sales, PR, technology and capital nights land directly. Their stated blocker is being stretched too thin — which is why session opt-in is emphasized throughout this brief.

03

Scaling & established

Capital & Command and The Endgame are built for them specifically. They scan for those two nights and register.

FOURTH READER, NOT AN ATTENDEE

Sponsors, partners and funders read this page too. They are not here for curriculum — they are here to see who to back. That is what the sponsor block is for, and it is also why the block must not interrupt founder conversion flow. See Section 13.

01 Sticky top banner

Global CTA consistency starts here.

COPY AUDIT Standardize the call-to-action label sitewide

The page currently uses three different labels — *Save your seat*, *Register for the Summit*, and *Save your free seat*. Repetition of one phrase is what makes a button feel like a decision rather than a series of unrelated links. Use the same label in all five places it appears.

BUTTON LABEL, EVERYWHERE

Save My Free Seat

First person converts measurably better on buttons. If the more formal register is preferred, *Save Your Free Seat* is the fallback — but then it must be used in all five places too.

JUSTIN Add the word Summit to the banner text

CURRENTLY ON THE PAGE

Forge The Future · free · virtual · Aug 10–20

REPLACE WITH

Forge The Future Summit · free · virtual · Aug 10–20

02 Hero

First screen. Carries the most weight and currently under-uses it.

JUSTIN

Remove the time estimate from the registration microcopy

CURRENTLY ON THE PAGE

Registration runs on Luma — about a minute, free.

REPLACE WITH

Free. Registration runs on Luma — your seat and calendar invite arrive together.

Keep the Luma name. It signals a real event with real infrastructure rather than a form on a landing page.

JUSTIN

Make VIRTUAL unmissable

Today the word *virtual* lives in a lowercase eyebrow at roughly 12px, and again inside the scrolling marquee. It is technically present and functionally invisible. Promote it to a display line directly above the H1 — set large, in gold, with real letterspacing — then reduce the existing eyebrow to the date range alone so the same fact is not stated twice.

NEW DISPLAY LINE ABOVE THE H1

A FREE VIRTUAL SUMMIT · AUG 10–20, 2026

COPY AUDIT

The hero does not say who the page is for

Not just education. Implementation. is a strong brand line and should stay as the H1. But a cold visitor arriving from an Instagram link self-identifies in under two seconds or leaves. One line beneath the existing subhead fixes it.

ADD BENEATH THE SUBHEAD

Built for founders who are past the idea and into the work.

COPY AUDIT

Ventriq is only identified in the footer

By the time a reader reaches the footer the decision is already made. Add a single trust line beneath the hero CTA.

ADD BENEATH THE CTA

Built by Ventriq — equipping entrepreneurs with capital, programming, and council.

COPY AUDIT

Add a persistent mobile CTA bar

Assume the majority of traffic is a phone, arriving from an Instagram bio link, scrolling one-handed. A fixed bottom bar carrying the CTA should follow the reader the entire length of the page. This is the highest-return structural change in the brief and it belongs in Tier 2.

03 Statistic strip

Four slots, one currently wasted.

COPY AUDIT Replace the duplicate figure

8 nights and *8 sessions* are the same fact stated twice — one of four slots is saying nothing new. Leading with roster size and closing on zero cost does considerably more work.

CURRENTLY ON THE PAGE

8 nights · 8 sessions · 90 minutes a night · 2 weeks

REPLACE WITH

8 nights · 17+ operators · 90 minutes a night · \$0

04 Countdown block

The page's one paragraph of persuasion. Rewritten in full.

JUSTIN New copy — inaugural framing, named disciplines, explicit implementation promise

CURRENTLY ON THE PAGE

Every August, the stages get bigger and the badges get pricier. This is the other thing. Eight nights in the summer. Ninety minutes at a time. People who've built, telling you exactly how — and a room that keeps the receipts. The resources are out there. For two weeks, they're not camouflaged.

REPLACE WITH

This is the first one. Eight nights, ninety minutes each, across every unit of the business you're building — brand, influence, sales, marketing and PR, technology, capital, and the exit you haven't thought about yet. You won't sit and take notes. You'll work on your own business in real time, in the room, with the people who've already done it.

Note on what was removed: the *bigger stages, pricier badges* framing has been cut here because the same idea is reused in the National Black Business Month block in Section 11. Stating it twice weakens both. Section 11 is the stronger home for it.

05 How it works — Step 1

Currently titled “Save your free seat.” Title stays.

JUSTIN New description

CURRENTLY ON THE PAGE

Takes a minute on Luma. Your confirmation email carries the calendar invite; add it before you forget.

REPLACE WITH

Free registration on Luma. Your confirmation arrives with the calendar invite attached — add it, and you're locked in for every night you choose.

COPY AUDIT Add a one-line ambassador prompt

The entire referral attribution model depends on registrants filling in the referral-name field on the Luma form, and nothing on the page currently tells anyone to do it. One small line recovers the data.

ADD BENEATH THE STEP, SET SMALL

Referred by someone? Add their name on the registration form.

06 How it works — Step 2

Currently titled “Show up live.” Title stays.

JUSTIN New description — engagement and session opt-in

CURRENTLY ON THE PAGE

Monday through Thursday nights, 6:30–8:00 PM ET, for two weeks. Seventy percent teaching, thirty percent your questions. Then Friday through Sunday — go build with it.

REPLACE WITH

Monday through Thursday, 6:30–8:00 PM ET. Choose your nights when you register — all eight, or only the ones your business needs. Every session is live and worked, not watched: exercises, breakouts, and real questions answered in the room.

This opt-in message is mirrored in two more places by design — beneath the schedule in Section 9 and in the FAQ in Section 12. A reader who is stretched too thin needs to hear it more than once before it registers as permission.

07 How it works — Step 3

Retitled. Pricing removed.

JUSTIN New section title

CURRENTLY ON THE PAGE

Keep the room.

REPLACE WITH &MDASH; RECOMMENDED

The room stays open.

ALTERNATES

Keep building. · After the eighth night. · What happens next.

⋮ *The room stays open* keeps the original idea, reads more elevated, and implies continuation rather than possession.

JUSTIN Remove the membership price point

CURRENTLY ON THE PAGE

Founders After Hours holds every replay 24 hours after each session, along with speaker office hours and the founders you met in the chat. Membership from \$39/month.

REPLACE WITH

Every session replays inside Founders After Hours 24 hours later — along with speaker office hours, and the founders you met in the chat. It's where two weeks turns into a practice.

COPY AUDIT The same figure appears in the FAQ

If pricing comes off here it must come off there too, or the page contradicts itself within one scroll. Replacement copy is in Section 12.

08 Speakers

Placeholder state understood. These four items apply regardless.

COPY AUDIT Correct the speaker count

The page claims thirty-plus builders. The confirmed roster is seventeen-plus. Overclaiming by thirteen is a credibility risk that buys nothing — seventeen operators is already the strongest asset on the page. Fix here and in the FAQ.

BOTH INSTANCES

Seventeen-plus builders, operators, and funders — no professional motivators.

COPY AUDIT Resolve the placeholder announcement date

ANNOUNCE-DATE appears here and in the FAQ. Replace with a real date, or cut the sentence entirely until there is one. A visible placeholder costs more than a missing date.

COPY AUDIT The speaker announcement link is a dead end

Get the speaker announcement → currently points at /contact. A contact form is not a notification signup. Every person who clicks that link is a warm lead being handed a generic form. Point it at the newsletter capture, or wire a single inline email field.

COPY AUDIT Keep the line about professional motivators

It is the sharpest line in the section and the clearest signal that this roster was curated rather than assembled. Whatever the grid becomes, that line survives.

COPY AUDIT Build the grid to render at any count

Names arrive in waves, not all at once. The grid should look deliberate at six, twelve, and seventeen — not assume fifteen tiles.

09 Two weeks, mapped

The highest-intent moment on the page. Three changes.

COPY AUDIT Add a plain-language discipline tag to each night

The session titles are beautiful and completely opaque to a cold scanner. *The Rainmaker's Craft* is elevated; it does not tell a stranger it is a sales night. A small uppercase tag alongside each title fixes this without touching the titles — and it is what allows the three audience tiers to self-select.

TAG EACH NIGHT

Aug 10 · The Weight and the Vision — **LEADERSHIP**

Aug 11 · The Art of Desire — **BRAND**

Aug 12 · Renowned — **MARKETING & PR**

Aug 13 · The Rainmaker's Craft — **SALES**

Aug 17 · The Modern Advantage — **TECHNOLOGY & AI**

Aug 18 · Capital & Command — **FINANCE & FUNDING**

Aug 19 · The Endgame — **EXIT STRATEGY**

Aug 20 · The End of the Beginning — **THE FOUNDER'S REALITY**

JUSTIN Add an RSVP button beneath the schedule

Correct instinct and the right placement. Someone who has just read all eight session titles has already decided — they should not have to scroll to the bottom of the page to act on it.

CURRENTLY ON THE PAGE

All sessions 6:30–8:00 PM ET. Fridays through Sundays are yours — go build with the week.

LINE ABOVE THE BUTTON

All sessions 6:30–8:00 PM ET. One registration, and you choose the nights. Fridays through Sundays are yours — go build with the week.

BUTTON

Save My Free Seat

MICROCOPY BELOW THE BUTTON

Free · virtual · one registration covers all eight nights

COPY AUDIT Leave the August 14–16 break exactly as it is

aug 14–16 · off — go build is the clearest signal on the page that this was designed by someone who runs a business. No change.

10 Who this is for

Replaced in full. Nonprofit builders cut.

JUSTIN Swap in the three audience tiers

CURRENTLY ON THE PAGE

Small business owners past the idea stage ... Startup founders from first traction to first raise ... Nonprofit builders who run their organization like founders, because they are.

REPLACE ALL THREE LINES

Idea-stage entrepreneurs — you have the vision and the nerve. What's missing is the blueprint, and the conviction to start before it's perfect.

Early-stage entrepreneurs — zero to three years in, revenue coming through the door, and every system in the business still running through you.

Scaling entrepreneurs — the thing works. Now the questions are capital, leverage, and what this becomes when you're not the one holding it up.

CLOSING LINE &MDASH; UNCHANGED

If you're serious, you belong here.

COPY AUDIT Open decision — do not resolve without Justin

The word *founders* appears roughly a dozen more times across the page: hero, FAQ, Founders After Hours, footer. The swap to *entrepreneurs* was scoped to this block only, and that is how it is written above. The recommendation is to hold it there — Founders After Hours locks the word into the brand, so a global swap would create a fresh inconsistency while fixing an intentional one. Flagged rather than decided.

11 National Black Business Month block

Rewritten. Outbound link removed.

JUSTIN New copy — no travel, bite-sized action, momentum into the fall

CURRENTLY ON THE PAGE

August is National Black Business Month, and every fall the big conferences arrive with big stages and bigger badges. This is the other thing: eight nights in the summer, ninety minutes at a time, where the point isn't who's in the room — it's what you do when you leave it. That's the whole Ventriq idea, in miniature.

REPLACE WITH

August is National Black Business Month. Most of what that means arrives as a conference — a flight, a hotel, a badge, and three days away from the business you're supposed to be building. This is the other thing. Ninety minutes a night, from the beach, the office, or the edge of your bed. Eight small deliberate moves instead of one big weekend. Come September, you won't have a lanyard. You'll have momentum.

ATTRIBUTION &MDASH; UNCHANGED

— Justin Shaw

JUSTIN Remove the Read the full story link

It leads nowhere useful, and the block is stronger ending on the attribution. A closing thought from the founder should not hand off to another page.

12 Questions, answered

One removed and replaced, one rewritten, two corrected, one added.

JUSTIN Remove “Will I be pitched?” — but replace it rather than delete it

The objection exists in the reader's head whether or not the page addresses it. The move is to retire the defensive framing and use the slot for a higher-value question — which is very likely the single biggest unasked objection blocking registrations from busy operators.

NEW QUESTION AND ANSWER

Do I have to attend all eight nights?

No. Choose your sessions when you register — one night, four, or all eight. Most founders come for the nights that map to what they're solving right now, then stay for the ones they didn't expect to need.

COPY AUDIT Rewrite “What if I can't make a session live?”

As written, the answer to *what if I miss one* is *pay thirty-nine dollars a month*. That is the wrong note in a free-event FAQ, and it now contradicts the pricing removal in Section 7.

CURRENTLY ON THE PAGE

Every replay lands in Founders After Hours 24 hours after the session — that's the membership community, from \$39/month. The live seat is the free one; save it and show up.

REPLACE WITH

Every replay lands in Founders After Hours 24 hours later — that's Ventriq's working community, where the summit keeps going. The live seat is the free one, and it's where the real work happens. Save it and show up.

COPY AUDIT Correct the speaker answer

Thirty-plus becomes seventeen-plus, and **ANNOUNCE-DATE** resolves or the sentence comes out.

COPY AUDIT Add a timezone question

National audience, 6:30 PM Eastern start. That is 3:30 in the afternoon on the West Coast — a real conflict for anyone with a day job, and a question that will otherwise arrive by email eighty times.

NEW QUESTION AND ANSWER

What time is this in my zone?

6:30–8:00 PM ET each night — 5:30 CT, 4:30 MT, 3:30 PT. The calendar invite in your confirmation will convert it for you automatically.

13 Sponsor block

Moved, and reframed for a for-profit entity.

COPY AUDIT Move the block below the FAQ

It currently sits between the mission statement and the FAQ, which means a founder mid-decision hits a block that is not addressed to them and loses momentum. Funders scroll further and with more patience than founders do. Place it after the FAQ and before the final call to action.

JUSTIN Reframe the copy away from philanthropic language

This matters more than the wording. *Underwritten* and *foundations* both signal philanthropic giving, and a foundation grant to a for-profit entity is a different and considerably harder transaction than a sponsorship. Reframe it as what it now is: commercial exposure.

CURRENTLY ON THE PAGE

Summit sessions can be underwritten by companies and foundations that want to reach serious founders — visibly and usefully.

REPLACE WITH

Summit sessions can be sponsored by companies and organizations that want to reach serious entrepreneurs — visibly and usefully.

No tax-deductibility language anywhere on the site, including the sponsor and contact pages.

14 Final call to action

Strong as written. One addition.

COPY AUDIT Reinforce that one registration covers everything

This is the last opportunity to remove the assumption that eight nights means eight commitments.

CURRENTLY ON THE PAGE

Aug 10–20 • 6:30–8:00 PM ET • live on Zoom • free

REPLACE WITH

Aug 10–20 • 6:30–8:00 PM ET • live on Zoom • free • one registration, all eight nights

15 Footer

Both lines change. One is urgent.

JUSTIN Identity line — nonprofit language removed

CURRENTLY ON THE PAGE

Ventriq (ven-TREEK) is a nonprofit equipping founders with capital, programming, and council — rooted in Baltimore, built to travel.

REPLACE WITH

Ventriq (ven-TREEK) equips entrepreneurs with capital, programming, and council — rooted in Baltimore, built to travel.

JUSTIN + AUDIT Copyright line — nonprofit language and internal legal note both removed

This is the Tier 1 item. The second half of the current line is an internal instruction that is live and public.

CURRENTLY ON THE PAGE

© 2026 Ventriq. A nonprofit organization. EIN — add when issued; no deductibility language until determination letter

REPLACE WITH

© 2026 Ventriq. All rights reserved.

16 Build notes

Not copy. Things that will cost real money if missed.

COPY AUDIT Mobile QA on the countdown timer and the scrolling marquee

Both are the most common elements to break at 375px, and both sit in the first screen a phone user sees.

COPY AUDIT Sticky anchor sub-navigation

Schedule · Speakers · FAQ · Register. The page is long; a slim persistent sub-nav measurably reduces mobile bounce.

COPY AUDIT Analytics and conversion tracking live before the partner push, not during it

There is a paid-retargeting decision gate on August 7. Without channel-level conversion data by August 1, that decision gets made blind.

COPY AUDIT End-to-end Luma test with a real submission

Including the referral-name field passing through correctly. A silent failure there costs the entire ambassador dataset, and it will not announce itself.

COPY AUDIT Build the Founders After Hours section behind a toggle

So it can be switched on the moment it is named from the stage on Night 1, without a deploy.

17 Sitewide

Two items that cannot wait for the rest of the site.

JUSTIN Standardize the event name to Forge The Future Summit

The page currently uses *Forge The Future* without the word Summit in the title tag, both meta descriptions, the top banner, and the hero eyebrow.

TITLE TAG

Forge The Future Summit — Ventriq's free virtual founder summit, Aug 10–20

META DESCRIPTION, OG AND TWITTER

Eight nights, two weeks — brand, PR, sales, technology, capital, exit. Every session ends with a move you can make the next morning. Free, virtual, live on Zoom.

Separate task, not for Derrick: the speaker graphics, partner toolkit email, Instagram captions and announcement email campaign currently all read *The Forge Summit*. Those are the assets that now change, not the site. Worth a sweep before the next distribution wave.

JUSTIN Remove nonprofit language across the site

Ventriq is a for-profit entity as of now. Five instances on the summit page are itemized in Sections 2, 13 and 15. The remaining pages almost certainly carry the same language and need the same pass.

PAGES TO SWEEP

/about · /founders-after-hours · /mastermind · /contact

No tax-deductibility language, no 501(c)(3) reference, no EIN placeholder, and no grant or donation framing anywhere on the site. The summit page ships first, but these follow before partner traffic starts moving across the site in early August.

✓ Summary

What this adds up to.

47

CHANGES

17

SECTIONS

14

COPY BLOCKS, FINAL

5

TIER 1, TODAY

1

OPEN DECISION

Every copy block in this document is finished and drop-in ready — no writing pass required on your end. The one open item is the *founders* versus *entrepreneurs* question in Section 10, which is written the recommended way and needs a yes before it becomes permanent. Anything unclear, ask before improvising: on this page a small wording change carries further than it looks.

Forged together. Built to last.